

CALIFORNIA OWNER-BUILDER PERMIT KIT

Qualify for the exemption · File the permit · Pass the inspections

Project Address: _____

City or County: _____

Owner-Builder: _____

Permit Application Date: _____

Every California statute, code edition, and threshold in this kit
is cited on the page it appears on — verified August 2026.

BUILD YOUR HOUSE

build-your-house.com

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How to Use This Kit

Five working documents that take a California owner-builder from "am I allowed to do this?" to a certificate of occupancy.

California gives you a single statewide building code — **Title 24** — and an exemption at **Business and Professions Code § 7044** that lets you build on your own land with no contractor's license. What it does not give you is one permit counter: **58 counties and hundreds of cities** each issue their own permits, and each may amend Title 24 locally. This kit separates what the State fixes, cited here, from what your jurisdiction adds, which you fill in.

WHAT IS IN THE KIT

The five documents

	Document	What it does for you
CA.1	Owner-Builder Exemption Walkthrough	Which of § 7044's four exemptions you are claiming, what you swear to, and the sale rule. Read this first.
CA.2	Permit Application Checklist	What to gather before you file — zoning, Title 24 energy, septic and well, fire zone, grading, school fees.
CA.3	Inspection Sequence	The order inspections happen in, the ones California adds that other states do not, and fields for dates and results.
CA.4	Where to File Directory	Which agency owns which piece of your project, how to find yours, and a page to write down what you confirmed.
CA.5	Forms & Documents Index	Each document you will meet: what it is, when, and from where.

HOW TO USE IT

- **Start with CA.1.** California's exemption is four separate exemptions with different conditions, and you must know which one you are claiming before you sign anything.
- **Fill in CA.4 before you need it.** A California house is spread across building, planning, environmental health, fire and the school district — find out which touch your parcel early.
- **Work CA.2 with a pen** and do not file until the boxes are checked. California plan review is slow enough without a second submittal.
- **Keep CA.3 on the job** and record every inspection date and result as it happens.

How these facts were checked — and what this is not

Every California claim here was read against its primary source in August 2026 and is cited where it appears — statute text at leginfo.legislature.ca.gov, code editions from the Building Standards Commission. Where jurisdictions differ, the kit says so and gives the verification step. This is a process reference, not legal advice. Every statute page cited prints its own amendment history — check it before you rely on the text.